

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*

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## Paige Turner

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*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

## INTRODUCTIONS

Paige Turner

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### *Investigative Arts Journalist*

Paige asks innocent questions with a recorder visibly running. Paige covers the art world the way other reporters cover city hall: money, power, access, and who benefits when everyone agrees not to ask a question.

- Keeps asking **Barb Dwyer** for access to museum records. **Barb** keeps asking what the story is about.
- **Sue Venir** has threatened to quote Paige's own articles back to her in court.
- Calls **Reed DeLabel** to check dates and catalogue references. **Reed** is delighted when a correction makes it into print.

### ACTING TIPS

Curious, direct, quick, socially fearless. Ask questions people wish you would save for email.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Paige Turner. I am covering the gala. Tell me what happened; tell your publicist what you wish had happened.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

# INTRODUCTIONS

Paige Turner

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## Behind the portrait

### Your grievance with Grant

You were preparing a major investigation into Grant's collection and labor empire. He discovered enough to threaten an injunction and promised to reveal the identity of one of your confidential museum sources if you published.

### Your other secret

You obtained internal documents through a source inside the Meridian. Protecting that source matters more to you than tonight's scoop.

### Conversations to start

- Find out whether Grant found the full provenance spreadsheet or only excerpts.
- Keep your source's identity protected.

*If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.*

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

## HUNT FOR CLUES

Paige Turner

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# The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1 *A green lamp cannot testify, but something near it can.*
- 2 *The house has its own cinema. Inspect the side the audience never sees.*
- 3 *A decorative vessel has traded its bouquet for evidence.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
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## ACT I: MOTIVE

Paige Turner

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### Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

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**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

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**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

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**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

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**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

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**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

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*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

## ACT I: MOTIVE

Paige Turner

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### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

#### EVERYONE / READ ALOUD

This is the part the press release left out. I was preparing an investigation into Grant's collection and labor empire. He threatened an injunction and exposure of a confidential museum source if I published. My reputation mattered, but protecting that source mattered more. He knew precisely where to apply pressure.

*You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

## ACT II: OPPORTUNITY

Paige Turner

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### Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

Where were you before the toast, and why?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

Where did your work take you before the toast?

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**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

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**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

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**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

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**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

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**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

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*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

## ACT II: OPPORTUNITY

Paige Turner

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### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

#### IF INNOCENT

My last inspection was inside the Star Bowl alcove, about 6:46 by the service-desk clock. I went there to copy the caption on the small side rail beside the bowl. My press copy did not quite agree with the display. Keeping my source safe mattered more than satisfying Grant's curiosity. I tried to question him in his salon before returning to the press notes.

#### IF MURDERER

My last inspection was inside the Star Bowl alcove, about 6:46 by the service-desk clock. I went there to copy the small dedication card through the cabinet's front glass. My press copy did not quite agree with the display. I tried to question him in his salon before returning to the press notes.

*You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
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## ACT III: METHOD

Paige Turner

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### Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What materials or records passed through your hands?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

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**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

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**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

Which objects or records need your explanation?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

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**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

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**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

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**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

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*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

## ACT III: METHOD

Paige Turner

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### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

### EVERYONE / READ ALOUD

A museum source gave me internal documents. Grant threatened to expose that source if I published. I will not identify them simply because someone puts a dramatic question to me over dinner. My confidential arrangement concerns documents and somebody's livelihood. It was not an arrangement to interfere with Grant's drink.

### Evidence Table / discovery index

- |                                  |                                   |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| 1. Gift agreement                | 9. Education reallocation         |
| 2. Shipping manifest / 1988      | 10. Donor Salon camera            |
| 3. A warning left behind         | 11. Donation entry / 1989         |
| 4. GRANT'S NIGHT OF GLORY        | 12. Closing reveal / concept      |
| 5. Treatment finding             | 13. Display proposal / superseded |
| 6. Donor agreement / margin copy | 14. Clock inspection slip         |
| 7. Auction result                | 15. Cancelled programme cue       |
| 8. Vincent Van Faux              | 16. Grant Larceny's toast         |



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
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## ACCUSATIONS

Paige Turner

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### Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

#### Your character name

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#### I accuse

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#### Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

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#### Best Actor

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#### Best Costume

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**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
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## COMING CLEAN

Paige Turner

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### The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

#### IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I protected the museum source who gave me internal documents. I changed the time of my inspection to cover that secret. The real job was to copy the caption on the small side rail beside the bowl. I did it before the curtain closed, not at the late time I gave you. The work was real; my timetable was dishonest. I did not poison Grant Larceny.

#### IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

This is the part the press release left out. I was preparing an investigation into Grant's collection and labor empire. He threatened an injunction and exposure of a confidential museum source if I published. My reputation mattered, but protecting that source mattered more. He knew precisely where to apply pressure. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*